

Intake Policy

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Intake policy — Phase 0

Status: draft for the first 20–30 item pilot.

Model: selective electronics reuse/refurbishment, not general waste collection.

Intake days: Tuesday and Saturday only, pre-approval required.

Public walk-in intake starts only after Council, Fair Trading, tenancy/landlord and insurance questions are resolved.

See PHASE-0-OPERATING-BLUEPRINT.md (PHASE-0-OPERATING-BLUEPRINT.md) for the research behind these rules.

Core rule

If we cannot identify a realistic reuse, repair, parts or lawful downstream route before an item arrives, we do not accept it.

No unattended dumping. No “leave it at the gate”. Rejected items leave with the person who brought them.

Pre-screen before arrival

Ask for:

- category
- make/model
- photos
- does it power on?
- known fault
- screen/panel damage
- battery damage/swelling/water/fire exposure
- account/activation-lock status
- charger/accessories
- quantity
- source/ownership
- whether it contains business/customer data

Respond with:

- ACCEPT
- ACCEPT SUBJECT TO INSPECTION

- REJECT
- NEED MORE INFORMATION

Priority accepts

Laptops / desktops / mini PCs

Prefer:

- business-class laptops
- quality consumer laptops
- MacBooks with Activation Lock removed
- mini PCs/desktops
- machines with useful SSD/RAM/parts even if repairable

2026 default retail target: Windows 11-compatible hardware. Windows 10 normal support ended 14 October 2025, but Microsoft now offers the consumer Extended Security Updates (ESU) programme in Australia through 12 October 2027 under current enrollment terms. A Windows 10 22H2 machine may therefore have a temporary supported resale path if that limitation is clearly disclosed; otherwise use a credible Linux, vintage, donor-parts or other value path.

Phones

Accept only when:

- battery is undamaged
- device is not fire/water damaged
- Apple/Google/manufacture locks can be legitimately removed
- IMEI/serial can be recorded
- current Australian network/000 compatibility can be verified before resale
- condition/value justify handling

3G-only and some older 4G devices are no longer viable on Australian networks after the 3G shutdown.

Tablets

Same lock/battery rules as phones. Tablets require their own downstream route; ordinary MobileMuster collections do not generally accept them.

TVs

By prior approval only.

Prefer:

- flat-panel only
- identifiable model
- intact panel
- working or plausibly economic to repair

- storage location already available

Other good electronics

By approval where there is a known market:

- consoles
- cameras
- quality audio
- vintage computing
- networking equipment
- useful PC components

Refuse at Phase 0

- CRT TVs/monitors
- cracked-panel TVs unless a specific safe/profitable parts route is already identified
- loose lithium batteries
- swollen/bulging/leaking/punctured/crushed/overheated batteries
- fire-affected battery devices
- water-submerged battery devices
- e-bike/e-scooter batteries
- vapes/e-cigarettes
- whitegoods
- printers/scanners unless pre-approved
- fluorescent lamps
- smoke alarms
- random mixed cable boxes
- contaminated/pest-infested electronics
- no-name/unsafe chargers and power supplies
- Apple devices with unresolved Activation Lock
- Android devices that cannot be legitimately cleared of account/device protection
- organisation-managed devices without authority to transfer
- suspicious provenance or removed/defaced serials without credible explanation
- bulk dead low-value electronics
- anything with no identified exit route

Four acceptance gates

An accepted device must pass the applicable gates:

1. Ownership/legal — credible authority to transfer.
2. Safety — no unacceptable battery/electrical/contamination hazard.
3. Value/technical — resale, repair, donor, collector or known recycling route.

4. Storage — a labelled shelf/bin position exists before acceptance.

Shelf full = intake paused for that category.

Intake record

Every accepted item receives a unique ID, for example DEW-2026-0001.

Record:

- date
- source
- transfer type
- make/model
- serial
- IMEI where relevant
- condition
- battery condition
- charger/accessories
- lock/account state
- data-bearing status
- known faults
- ownership/authority statement
- initial route
- photos

If Fair Trading confirms a second-hand dealer licence is required, this record must be expanded to the prescribed statutory fields/reporting process.

Data workflow

Every data-bearing device goes immediately to:

UNWIPED — RESTRICTED

Workflow:

1. identify/record media
2. remove legitimate account/activation locks at handover where possible
3. store unwiped devices securely
4. sanitise using media-appropriate method
5. verify result
6. record method/date/operator/result
7. mark SANITISED
8. only then move to repair, parts or resale

Do not retain customer Apple/Google passwords.

Marketing language at Phase 0:

Documented secure data erasure

Do not advertise “certified data destruction” unless a later process/accreditation genuinely supports that claim.

Battery rule

Phase 0 does not operate a battery drop-off service.

- visually inspect battery-bearing devices before acceptance
- reject damaged/swollen/wet/fire-affected battery devices
- never use or charge a damaged battery
- no unattended or overnight charging
- use compatible/compliant chargers
- stop testing if abnormal heat, smell, swelling or noise occurs
- use an accredited/authorised downstream route for battery waste

Do not place badly damaged/swollen batteries into an ordinary B-cycle drop point.

Testing before resale

Computers

At minimum, where applicable:

- serial/identity
- visual condition
- POST/boot
- CPU/RAM/storage detection
- storage health
- battery health
- keyboard/trackpad
- display
- webcam/mic/speakers
- Wi-Fi/Bluetooth
- ports
- charging
- thermals/fan
- sleep/wake
- clean supported OS setup
- recall/product-safety check
- charger compliance

- defects recorded

Phones/tablets

- serial/IMEI
- lock removed
- clean reset/setup
- Australian network compatibility for phones
- display/touch
- cameras
- speaker/mic
- charging
- Wi-Fi/Bluetooth
- buttons/biometrics
- battery condition
- recall/safety check
- defects recorded

TVs/monitors

- model/serial
- intact panel
- power/image/backlight
- ports
- audio
- buttons/remote
- abnormal heat/smell
- recall check
- defects recorded

Resale

Second-hand goods sold by a business remain subject to Australian Consumer Law.

For every sale:

- give accurate make/model/spec
- use consistent condition grading
- show clear photos
- disclose known faults
- identify included charger/accessories
- retain serial/asset ID
- keep test record
- issue receipt/invoice as required
- keep buyer/contact records required by law and enough to act on later safety issues

Do not use “no refunds” or “sold as-is” wording to imply statutory consumer rights do not apply.

Storage zones

Use clearly labelled areas:

1. INTAKE / UNASSESSED
2. UNWIPE — RESTRICTED
3. TEST / REPAIR
4. READY FOR SALE
5. DONOR / PARTS
6. OUTBOUND RECYCLING
7. QUARANTINE / STOP

Rules:

- no outdoor stock
- no stock on damp floors
- no stock against damp/mould-affected surfaces
- no device without an asset ID
- no miscellaneous pile
- each zone has a physical capacity
- zone full = pause intake

The existing shed must be demonstrated dry, secure and suitable before storing valuable or unwiped electronics there.

Downstream

Before public intake, confirm:

- Australian Metal Recycling Dubbo categories/fees/lithium rules and the named downstream recycler
- NTCRS option for TVs/computers/peripherals
- MobileMuster option for dead phones/chargers/accessories
- safe damaged-battery pathway
- whether AMR can provide a weight ticket/certificate of recycling for small commercial loads
- whether any downstream facility in the AMR chain is AS 5377 certified

Data-bearing rule: do not rely on ordinary AMR recycling as evidence of data destruction. Sanitise media first or remove HDD/SSD/NVMe storage for a separately verified destruction path.

Battery rule: AMR's site simultaneously lists laptops/phones/tablets and excludes lithium-ion material. Do not send battery-equipped devices to AMR until the Dubbo yard confirms exactly how that rule works.

See WHAT-HAPPENS-TO-EWASTE.md (WHAT-HAPPENS-TO-EWASTE.md) for the detailed downstream trace.

Do not treat the household CRC as an assumed commercial waste-disposal service.

Sources

See PHASE-0-OPERATING-BLUEPRINT.md (PHASE-0-OPERATING-BLUEPRINT.md), especially sections 2, 6–16 and 26. See also BACKLOG-21-25-COMPLIANCE-DATA-SAFETY.md (BACKLOG-21-25-COMPLIANCE-DATA-SAFETY.md) for the current Windows ESU, ACL, sanitisation, WHS and transport corrections.